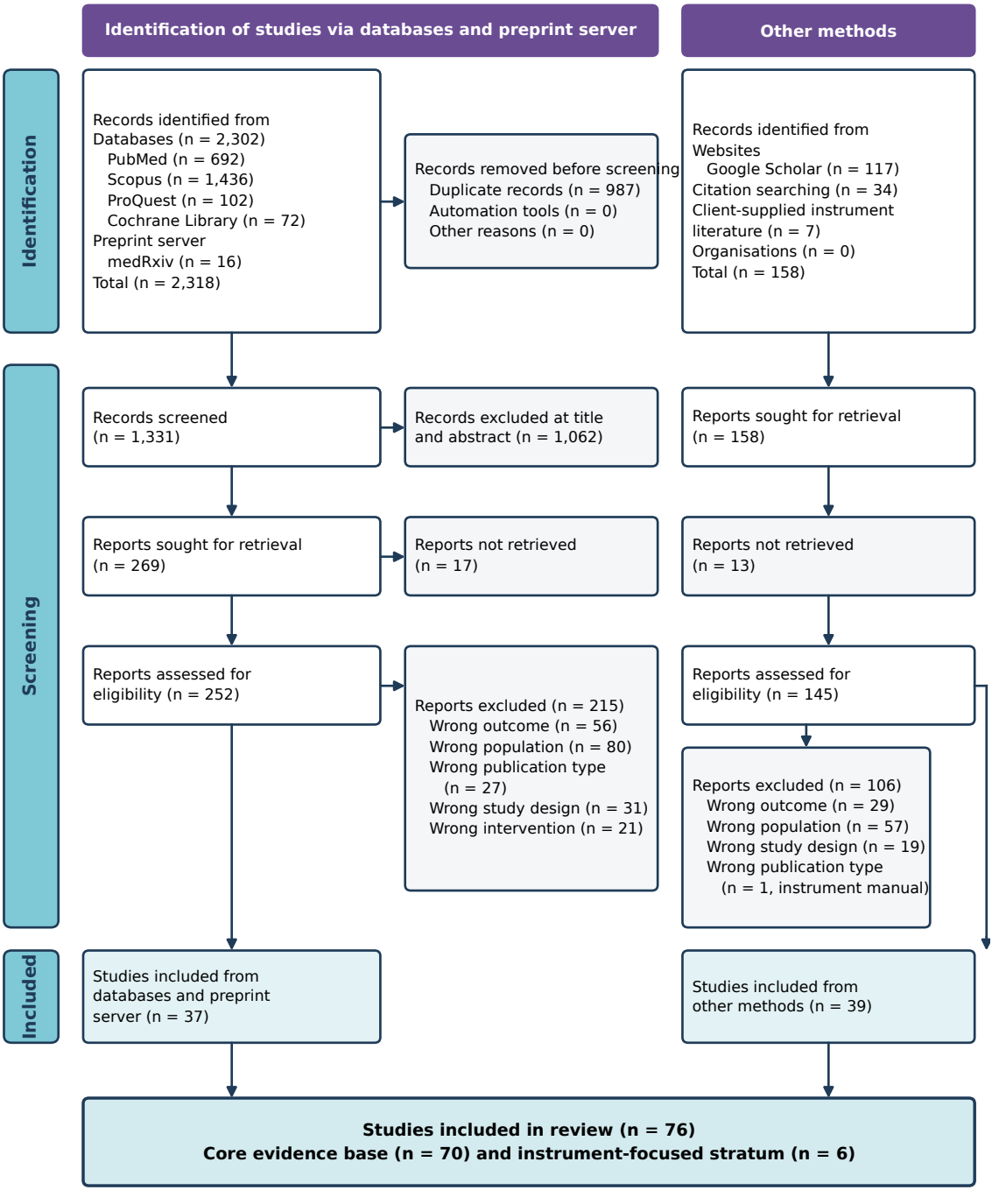
Identification of studies via databases and preprint server
Other methods
Identification
Screening
Included
Records identified from
Databases (n = 2,302)
PubMed (n = 692)
Scopus (n = 1,436)
ProQuest (n = 102)
Cochrane Library (n = 72)
Preprint server
medRxiv (n = 16)
Total (n = 2,318)
Records removed before screening
Duplicate records (n = 987)
Automation tools (n = 0)
Other reasons (n = 0)
Records identified from
Websites
Google Scholar (n = 117)
Citation searching (n = 34)
Client-supplied instrument
literature (n = 7)
Organisations (n = 0)
Total (n = 158)
Records screened
(n = 1,331)
Records excluded at title
and abstract (n = 1,062)
Reports sought for retrieval
(n = 158)
Reports sought for retrieval
(n = 269)
Reports not retrieved
(n = 17)
Reports not retrieved
(n = 13)
Reports assessed for
eligibility (n = 252)
Reports excluded (n = 215)
Wrong outcome (n = 56)
Wrong population (n = 80)
Wrong publication type
(n = 27)
Wrong study design (n = 31)
Wrong intervention (n = 21)
Reports assessed for
eligibility (n = 145)
Reports excluded (n = 106)
Wrong outcome (n = 29)
Wrong population (n = 57)
Wrong study design (n = 19)
Wrong publication type
(n = 1, instrument manual)
Studies included from
databases and preprint
server (n = 37)
Studies included from
other methods (n = 39)
Studies included in review (n = 76)
Core evidence base (n = 70) and instrument-focused stratum (n = 6)